

Plancheck Submittal for Trailer, Conex Offices, Conex Storage

NOTE: that this list is intended to be a general list of required plans and information for the most common types of tenant improvements. More complex or unique projects may require additional information, plans, or reports. It is recommended to contact the BIO department prior to submittal to discuss any special considerations or requirements that may apply to your project.

This document addresses the SLAC requirements for Temporary Trailers, Storage Containers, and Storage Containers with Offices. Temporary trailers, storage containers, and storage containers with offices are authorized for the duration of the project (not to exceed three years) and must be removed. The affected area restored to a clean and safe condition upon completion of the project. Submit plans to BIO demonstrating compliance with all of the items listed below.

1. Traffic Safety: Provide a traffic safety plan of the construction / project site, parking areas, roadways. Plans shall include vehicle barriers and signage per Caltrans Section 12 of the Caltrans Standard Specification and the Manual of Uniform Traffic Control Devices (MUTCD) standards. Include project parking plan.
2. Fire Department Access: Maintain unobstructed Fire Department Access to and around the containers and/or trailer(s). Trailer and containers cannot obstruct existing fire access as per California Fire Code Including Appendices. Fire Department Access plan shall address egress, entrances and fire protection equipment for surrounding areas or buildings. Plan shall include all fire hydrants, Fire Department Connections (FDC), Fire Sprinkler Risers.
3. Fire Exposure to Existing Buildings or Buildings Under Construction: Place project trailers / containers a minimum of thirty (30') feet from existing buildings or buildings under construction, in accordance with the latest edition of NFPA 241, Section 4.2 requirements. Project Trailers or containers over twenty (20') feet in length will require greater separation distances per the NFPA table. The primary mitigation if a temporary trailer or container must be placed closer to the work area is to require a trailer or container to be of noncombustible construction. In some cases fire sprinklers may be required in addition to no combustible construction.
4. Electrical Safety: Electrical must comply with NEC Article 590. Obtain a BIO Inspection prior to energizing cords used for power. Cords exposed to the weather shall have a "W" rating as part of the cable type ie: SOW, SOOW, or Just W. Finely stranded cable must use approved terminations for that type of cable. Cable shall be sized too full panel buss bar load. Power skids shall be anchored to prevent movement.
5. Temporary Generator Power: Those wishing to use temporary power generators for field office power must comply with SLAC temporary power guidelines, BAAQMD air quality permits requirements, SLAC Electrical Safety Office requirements for those persons who can operate a generator. Show location of generator, Size of generator, fueling area, power connection to office trailer / container, Spill containment supplies, Fire Extinguisher size, type and location. Any generator staying more than 30 days is treated as equipment and must be seismically anchored. Provide Plan(s) and calculations. See Page 3 for additional safety information.



All generators 15, 20 & 30 amp 120 & 120/240 V plugs shall be GFCI protected. Additional 480 volt circuits used for power skids or equipment need to be GFCI protected to protect personnel.

6. Temporary Communications / Data: SLAC communications requires all project trailers to have a communications conduit installed from a building to the trailer for phone & computer data connections. Minimum size of 1".
7. Environmental Impact: All trailers / containers sites must comply with SLAC site specific SWPPP, BMP, approved drainage, fencing and provide for safe pedestrian routes in affected area(s)
8. Building Identification number: Obtain a building address from Space Planning Department. Post address on trailer to allow identification of the trailer / conex or container by emergency responders during an emergency. Signs shall be on metal with white background and red numbers. Posted on exterior in the upper left hand corner. Typically, a number starting with a "T" ie T-#### for trailers and 4#### for conex / containers
9. Water and Sanitation: Show on plans the locations of the sanitary facilities or port a potties and hand wash locations. Show route of sewer and water lines including sizes and type of material.
10. Accessibility Compliant: Office Trailers & Office Conex shall be accessibility compliant including ramp, stairs, parking space, Interior floor plan identifying disabled desks. Bathrooms in trailers shall be accessibility compliant. Accessibility requires all project office trailers & conex office to be accessible.
11. Storage Containers & Office /Storage Containers: On ground shall be staked at each corner to prevent movement (3/4" x 36" stakes or equal one each corner), fire extinguisher. Alternate anchor designs will be on a case by case basis for those boxes elevated to obtain a level box or over pavement. Rebar covers may be needed for those stakes sticking out past the conex containers. Does not apply to existing Conex boxes, unless they are moved. Conex and Shipping Container are the same thing.

Excerpt Seismic Design Specification for Buildings, Structures, Equipment, and Systems 2023 Section 1.2 Non-Permanent Modular / Portable Buildings or Temporary trailers must be anchored with straps to the ground as designed by a licensed structural engineer.

12. Submit plans to the BIO PRS system for review and approvals. Plans to be submitted in unlocked PDF format into the PRS system,

Plans shall include at a minimum:

- a) Location on SLAC property
 - b) Electrical power, cable runs, generator locations, Power Skids, Calculations, etc.
 - c) Communications conduit type and size, wire type
 - d) Trailer anchorage plan including pier stand layout and seismic tie down drawings and calculations,
- Plans and calculations must be stamped and signed.



- e) Statement of use with estimated duration of use
- f) Building Identification Number for trailers.
- g) Water Connections, size piping, routing, etc.
- h) Show location of bathroom facilities, Porta Potties, Hand Wash Stations.
- i) Waste disposal plan if restrooms are provided in trailer(s).
- J) Show location of ramp and accessible compliant parking space for trailers.
- k) Vendor Installation documents for any equipment.
- l) Include all work located in last three pages of this document – see below.

Plan Review Times:

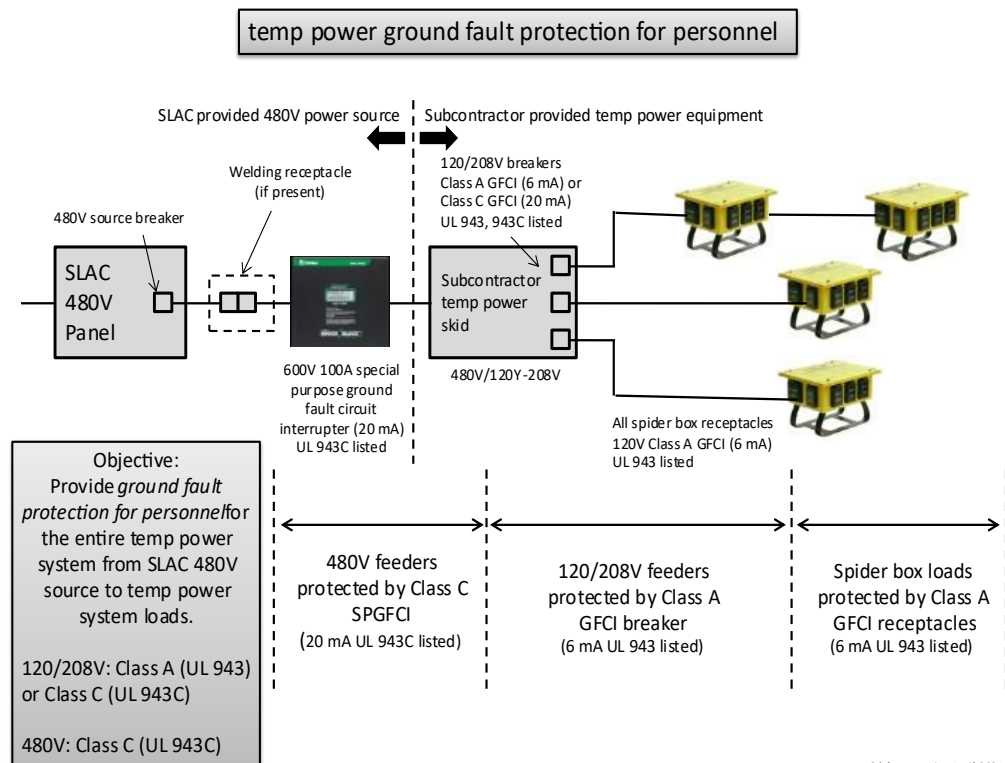
First Submittal: 5 Business Day

All Subsequent Submittals: 5 Business Days each submittal

All new submittals incur up to an additional 3 business days for routing to plan reviewers and 3 Business days after when review is complete for processing. Resubmittals incur 3 business days to send to review. Once plans are approved allow the Building Inspection Office up to 3 business days to prepare for permit issuance.

All permit notifications will be made by email including the issuance of permits.

10/29/25



Interpretations provided by Kevin Brenton CASP #964 on 10/28/25

Subject: Accessibility requirements for Construction trailers

1. Accessibility Requirements for Construction Trailers at SLAC

Construction trailers used on SLAC projects must comply with the accessibility requirements of the California Building Code (CBC), Chapter 11B, and with federal accessibility obligations under the Architectural Barriers Act (ABA). In plain terms: if SLAC employees, consultants, inspectors, or other SLAC project stakeholders are expected to enter the trailer, then the trailer is considered part of the employee work environment and must be accessible.

At a minimum, the following elements must be provided:

1.1 Accessible Parking for Trailer

There must be an accessible route from the site arrival point to the trailer entrance. This route must be firm, stable, and slip-resistant (no loose gravel, mud, or uneven plywood). Running slope along the route cannot exceed 1:20 (5%). If it does, a compliant ramp is required. Cross slope should not exceed 1:48 (about 2%). If dedicated parking or a designated inspection/visitor stall is provided adjacent to the trailer, at least one of those spaces must meet accessible parking requirements (width, access aisle, signage, slope).

1.2 Accessible Entry and Landing

The primary entrance used by SLAC personnel must be accessible. You cannot send disabled employees or inspectors to a "back door" that contractors don't actually use. Where the trailer is elevated above grade (common with jobsite office trailers), a compliant ramp and landing system must be provided: Maximum running slope of the ramp is 1:12 (8.33%). Maximum rise between level landings is 30 inches. Minimum clear ramp width is typically 36 inches. Landings at the top and bottom must be level (not more than 1:48 slope in any direction) and sized to allow approach, turning, and door operation. Guardrails and handrails must comply where required by height.

1.3 Door and Hardware

The entry door serving SLAC personnel must meet accessibility requirements: Door hardware must be operable with one hand, without tight grasping, pinching, or twisting of the wrist (i.e. lever-style, not round knobs). Opening force must be limited per CBC 11B for interior and exterior doors (typically requiring reasonable effort, not a heavy pull). Clear opening width must be at least 32 inches when the door is open 90 degrees. Maneuvering clearances on both sides of the door must be provided so a wheelchair user can approach, open, and pass through safely. Door thresholds must be beveled and typically not exceed 1/2 inch in height.

1.4 Circulation and Interior Clearances

The interior layout of the trailer must allow for an accessible route through the trailer where SLAC Personnel are expected to work or meet. Circulation aisles and walking paths should generally be at least 36 inches clear.



Furniture, filing cabinets, plan tables, and equipment cannot create choke points that block access to the workstation, meeting area, or conference table.

Where a conference table or meeting station is provided for coordination meetings, at least one seating position must have knee/toe clearance and accessible approach.

1.5 Work Areas / Employee Use Areas

Areas where SLAC employees are expected to enter, review drawings, sign documents, participate in OAC meetings, receive safety briefings, or discuss field changes must be on an accessible route and be enterable. CBC 11B requires that employee work areas be designed so that an employee with a disability can approach, enter, and exit the space. This includes inspectors, project managers, safety personnel, and others acting in the course of their duties.

1.6 Restrooms (If Provided Within or Directly Serving the Trailer)

If the trailer or the immediate trailer compound provides restrooms intended for use by SLAC personnel, at least one restroom must be accessible.

Door, clear floor space, turning radius, grab bars, fixture heights, lavatory knee clearance, and hardware must all comply.

If no restroom is provided within the trailer, but portable restrooms are provided for shared project use, at least one of those units must be an accessible portable toilet, located on an accessible route (not in a muddy slope behind caution tape).

1.7 Signage

Permanent rooms and spaces that are required to be identified (such as restrooms) must be compliant tactile signage and mounting height.

Directional signage may be required where the accessible entrance is not the same as the “typical” Entrance — but note: for SLAC work, the expectation is that the accessible entrance is the primary entrance, not an alternate entrance around the back of a generator.

2. Why the “Construction Trailer Exemption” Does Not Apply at SLAC

In some jurisdictions, contractors argue that construction trailers are “temporary field offices,” used only by the contractor’s personnel and therefore do not have to meet full accessibility standards. That argument does not apply at SLAC for the following reasons:

2.1 SLAC Employees Must Enter the Trailers

These trailers are routinely accessed by SLAC inspectors, SLAC project managers, SLAC safety/ESH personnel, engineering staff, and other SLAC stakeholders for normal project coordination activities. That means the trailer is not an isolated contractor-only space. It is part of the active work environment for SLAC employees.

Once SLAC personnel are expected or required to enter the trailer to perform their job duties, the trailer is considered an employee-use area. CBC 11B applies to employee work areas, including the requirement that an employee with a disability be able to approach, enter, and exit. Because SLAC employees are part of that expected user group, the “contractor only” argument is invalid.

2.2 Federal Accessibility Obligations Apply

SLAC operates under Department of Energy oversight and is subject to federal accessibility obligations, including the Architectural Barriers Act (ABA). The ABA requires accessible design for facilities where federal employees or federal contractors perform work on behalf of federal operations. A construction trailer used for SLAC project administration is part of that work environment.



In other words: this is not a private contractor's yard with no owner access. This is a workspace serving a DOE national laboratory. That triggers accessibility.

2.3 Duration and Function Matter More Than the Word "Temporary"

"Temporary" does not mean "exempt." The code does not say, "If you call it temporary and put it on blocks, you don't have to comply." If the trailer is being used for ongoing project management, document control, coordination

meetings, scope changes, RFIs, safety briefings, and official communication between SLAC and contractors, it is serving as an administrative office for active work. It is, functionally, an office occupancy.

If it functions like an office, and SLAC personnel are required to interact in that space, it must comply like an office.

2.4 Access Is Part of SLAC's Obligation as an Employer

SLAC cannot place work duties, sign-off responsibilities, plan review discussions, or safety briefings in a location that is physically inaccessible to a SLAC employee with a mobility impairment. Doing so would effectively exclude that employee from performing their job duties, which is not allowed.

Because SLAC business is being conducted inside these trailers, SLAC is responsible for ensuring that access is provided.

3. Summary / Recommended Compliance Statement

The jobsite construction trailers are considered active workspaces that SLAC personnel are required to enter for project coordination, review of documents, safety discussions, and administrative functions. Because these trailers are used by SLAC employees and not exclusively by a single contractor, they are subject to the accessibility requirements of CBC Chapter 11B and to federal accessibility obligations under the Architectural Barriers Act.

As a result, the trailer must provide:

- An accessible parking for the construction trailer.
- A compliant ramp and level landing at the entrance if the trailer is elevated.
- Accessible door clearances, thresholds, and hardware.
- Adequate interior circulation and meeting space on an accessible route.
- An accessible restroom serving SLAC personnel, if restrooms are provided for use at that trailer.

The common "temporary construction trailer" exemption does not apply at SLAC because SLAC employees are expected to access and conduct official business in these trailers.

Accessibility is required.

